

Auspiciousness of the Three Families

Trikulamaṅgala · Toh 825 · Derge Kangyur

རྒྱལ་ཁབ་འཕུལ་བའི་གྲི་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་མོ་།

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families (in Tibetan, Rigs gsum gyi bkra shis) is a short verse text of blessing, found as Toh 825 in the Kangyur. After paying homage to the Three Jewels, it invokes the auspiciousness of the three bodhisattvas who embody the principal buddha families: Mañjuśrī, bearing sword and book as signs of wisdom; Avalokiteśvara, radiant as the moon and holding a lotus as a sign of compassion; and Vajrapāṇi, deep blue-black and holding a vajra as a sign of the unchanging nature of reality. Each stanza describes the deity's appearance and the meaning of his emblems, then asks that the deity's sacred auspiciousness bring well-being and goodness to the present occasion. Texts of this kind are auspicious verses, recited to bless a gathering or undertaking, and this one belongs among the miscellaneous tantra-related and ritual works of the Kangyur, where short invocations of this sort are gathered.

It is complete. Auspiciousness of the Three Families.

I pay homage to the Three Jewels.

As a sign of his perfected qualities, his body is the color of gold.

As a sign of wisdom, he holds in his hands a sword and a book.

Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the noble Mañjuśrī, the youthful one,

By that sacred auspiciousness, may there be well-being and goodness here today.

As a sign of compassion, his body shines with the radiance of the moon.

Unstained by any fault, he holds in his hand a lotus as his emblem.

Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the noble Avalokiteśvara,

By that sacred auspiciousness, may there be well-being and goodness here today.

As a sign of the unchanging nature of reality, his body is a deep blue-black.

Holding in his hand a vajra, the inseparable union of skillful means and wisdom,

Whatever auspiciousness belongs to the noble Vajrapāṇi,

By that

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off in the middle of the third verse, so the translation ends where the Tibetan ends. The opening word, which closes a previous text, is rendered as a colophon-style marker; the title that follows is the beginning of this text. The phrase describing Vajrapāṇi's vajra is read as the union of skillful means and wisdom, a standard doctrinal association, with "inseparable" rendering the sense of non-duality.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.